GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

SAFEGUARDING POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Safeguarding Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Designated Safeguarding Lead	**Abdullah AS Patel**
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Data Protection Policy, Complaints Policy, Due Diligence Policy, Partner Selection Due Diligence Policy, Equality Diversity and Inclusion Policy

1. Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community. The Charity collects and distributes Zakat (obligatory Islamic almsgiving) and Sadaqah (voluntary charity) to eligible beneficiaries.

The Charity is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all people who come into contact with its work, particularly children and adults at risk. This includes beneficiaries, volunteers, trustees, and members of the public.

This policy sets out the Charity's approach to safeguarding, the responsibilities of trustees and volunteers, and the procedures for reporting and responding to safeguarding concerns.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Protect children and adults at risk who receive support from the Charity or come into contact with its activities
- Provide trustees and volunteers with clear guidance on their safeguarding responsibilities
- Establish procedures for identifying, reporting, and responding to safeguarding concerns
- Ensure compliance with relevant legislation and Charity Commission guidance
- Create a culture where safeguarding is everyone's responsibility
- Demonstrate to donors, partners, and the public that the Charity takes safeguarding seriously

3. Scope

This policy applies to all trustees and volunteers of the Charity. It also sets out expectations for partner organisations that work with the Charity.

The Charity will ensure this policy is put into practice, is responsive to change, is reviewed annually (and always following a serious incident), is available to the public, and complies with all relevant legislation.

4. Definitions

Safeguarding: The actions taken to promote the welfare of children and adults at risk and protect them from harm. This includes preventing harm, protecting those at risk, and responding appropriately when harm occurs.

Child: Anyone under the age of 18.

Adult at risk: An adult who has needs for care and support, is experiencing or at risk of abuse or neglect, and as a result of those care and support needs is unable to protect themselves from either the risk of, or the experience of, abuse or neglect.

Abuse: Any action that causes harm or distress to another person. This includes physical, emotional, sexual, financial abuse, neglect, and exploitation. See Appendix A for more detail.

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL): A trustee appointed to provide oversight of safeguarding matters and to lead on any incident investigation and reporting.

5. Safeguarding Principles

The Charity is committed to the following principles:

- The welfare of children and adults at risk is paramount
- Nobody who is involved in our work should ever experience abuse, harm, neglect, or exploitation
- All trustees and volunteers have a responsibility to promote the welfare of beneficiaries and to work in a way that protects them
- We have a collective responsibility for creating a culture in which people feel safe and able to speak up if they have concerns
- All concerns and allegations of abuse will be taken seriously and responded to promptly and appropriately
- We will work with statutory agencies and other organisations to protect children and adults at risk

6. Safeguarding Context

The Charity's activities that may involve contact with children or adults at risk include:

- **Beneficiary assessments:** Meetings with individuals or families to assess eligibility for Zakat or Sadaqah support. These may take place at neutral venues, partner premises, or occasionally at beneficiaries' homes
- **Grant distribution:** Providing financial assistance to individuals and families experiencing poverty or hardship, some of whom may be vulnerable
- **Partner working:** Working with partner organisations (such as refugee support organisations, mosques, and community groups) who may have direct contact with vulnerable people
- **Events and fundraising:** Occasional events where children or vulnerable adults may be present
- **Processing sensitive information:** Handling personal and financial information about beneficiaries, including their circumstances of need

Many of the Charity's beneficiaries may be in vulnerable circumstances due to poverty, refugee or asylum status, health issues, or other factors. The Charity recognises this and takes appropriate steps to safeguard their welfare.

7. Types of Abuse

Abuse can take many forms, including:

- **Physical abuse:** Hitting, slapping, pushing, kicking, restraint, or inappropriate physical sanctions
- **Emotional or psychological abuse:** Threats, intimidation, humiliation, isolation, or persistent criticism
- **Sexual abuse:** Any sexual activity to which a person has not consented or could not consent
- **Financial or material abuse:** Theft, fraud, exploitation, pressure in connection with wills or property
- **Neglect:** Failure to provide necessities of life, ignoring medical or physical care needs
- **Discriminatory abuse:** Abuse based on race, gender, disability, faith, sexual orientation, or age
- **Domestic abuse:** Physical, sexual, psychological, or financial abuse between people in a close relationship
- **Modern slavery:** Human trafficking, forced labour, domestic servitude

Further details of types of abuse and potential signs are provided in Appendix A and Appendix B.

8. Designated Safeguarding Lead

The Board of Trustees will appoint one of its members as the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL). The DSL is responsible for:

- Providing oversight of safeguarding across the Charity
- Being the first point of contact for safeguarding concerns
- Leading on any safeguarding incident investigation
- Making referrals to statutory agencies (police, social services) where appropriate
- Ensuring the Charity Commission is notified of serious safeguarding incidents
- Keeping up to date with safeguarding legislation and best practice
- Providing an annual safeguarding report to the Board
- Ensuring safeguarding is reflected in the Charity's risk register

9. Responsibilities

9.1 Board of Trustees

The Board has overall responsibility for safeguarding. This includes:

- Approving and reviewing this policy annually
- Appointing a Designated Safeguarding Lead from among the trustees
- Creating a culture of respect in which everyone feels safe and able to speak up
- Ensuring safeguarding risk assessments are carried out
- Ensuring appropriate checks are carried out when recruiting volunteers for roles involving contact with vulnerable people
- Ensuring all trustees and volunteers are aware of this policy
- Responding to concerns sensitively and acting quickly to address them
- Complying with Charity Commission guidance on safeguarding
- Ensuring any issues are properly investigated and dealt with quickly, fairly, and sensitively

9.2 All Trustees and Volunteers

All trustees and volunteers are responsible for:

- Being aware of and following this policy
- Being alert to the signs of potential abuse (see Appendix B)
- Reporting any concerns immediately to the Designated Safeguarding Lead
- Completing any required safeguarding training
- Conducting themselves appropriately when in contact with beneficiaries
- Maintaining appropriate boundaries

10. Safer Recruitment

The Charity will take appropriate steps when recruiting volunteers, particularly for roles that involve regular contact with children or adults at risk.

10.1 DBS Checks

Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks may be required for volunteers whose roles involve:

- Regular unsupervised contact with children
- Regular unsupervised contact with adults at risk
- Home visits to beneficiaries

The Board will assess which roles require DBS checks based on the nature and frequency of contact with vulnerable people. A record will be kept of DBS checks and their renewal dates.

10.2 References and Induction

References may be sought for volunteers in roles involving contact with vulnerable people. All new trustees and volunteers will be made aware of this safeguarding policy as part of their induction.

11. Reporting Concerns

11.1 Immediate Danger

If a crime is in progress or an individual is in immediate danger, call the police on 999.

11.2 Reporting to the Charity

If you have a safeguarding concern that does not involve immediate danger:

- **Trustees and volunteers:** Report your concern to the Designated Safeguarding Lead as soon as possible. If the DSL is unavailable or the concern involves the DSL, report to the Chair or another trustee
- **Beneficiaries or members of the public:** Contact any trustee of the Charity to raise your concern
- Contact details for trustees are available on the Charity Commission website and the Charity's own communications

11.3 What to Do If Someone Discloses Abuse

If someone tells you they have been abused or you witness abuse:

- Stay calm and listen carefully
- Take what they say seriously
- Reassure them that they are not to blame and that they were right to tell someone
- Do not promise to keep secrets – explain you may need to share information to keep them safe
- Do not ask leading questions or investigate yourself
- Make a written record as soon as possible, noting what was said, when, and by whom
- Report to the Designated Safeguarding Lead immediately

12. Responding to Concerns

When a safeguarding concern is reported, the Designated Safeguarding Lead will:

- Assess the information and decide on the appropriate response
- Make a referral to the police or local authority safeguarding team if appropriate
- Ensure the immediate safety of anyone at risk
- Keep confidential records of the concern and actions taken
- Report to the Board of Trustees
- Consider whether the matter constitutes a serious incident that must be reported to the Charity Commission
- Cooperate with any investigation by statutory agencies

The trustees are mindful of their reporting obligations to the Charity Commission in respect of Serious Incident Reporting and are aware of the Government guidance on handling safeguarding allegations.

13. Fundraising

In relation to fundraising, the Charity will:

- Comply with the Code of Fundraising Practice
- Ensure fundraising materials are accessible, clear, and ethical
- Not place undue pressure on individuals to donate
- Not solicit or accept donations from anyone who may not be competent to make their own decisions
- Be sensitive to any particular needs that a donor may have

14. Online Safety

The Charity will manage online risks by:

- Ensuring trustees and volunteers understand how to keep themselves and others safe online
- Using appropriate privacy settings and password protection for online meetings
- Protecting personal data in accordance with data protection legislation
- Obtaining permission before displaying any images on the Charity's website or social media
- Making clear how users can report online concerns

15. Working with Partner Organisations

The Charity works with partner organisations to deliver its charitable purposes. In doing so, the Charity will:

- Carry out appropriate due diligence on partner organisations
- Require partners to have their own safeguarding procedures that meet at least the standards in this policy
- Include safeguarding requirements in partnership agreements
- Monitor partners' compliance with safeguarding requirements

16. Record Keeping and Confidentiality

The Charity will:

- Keep accurate and secure records of any safeguarding concerns and actions taken
- Store safeguarding records securely with access restricted to those who need to know
- Retain records in accordance with data protection requirements
- Share information with statutory agencies where necessary to protect someone from harm

17. Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees at least annually, and always following a serious safeguarding incident. Reviews will also take place if there are changes to relevant legislation or Charity Commission guidance.

18. Related Guidance

Charity Commission Guidance:

- Safeguarding and protecting people for charities and trustees
- 10 actions trustees need to take to ensure good safeguarding governance
- How to report a serious incident in your charity
- Protecting charities from harm – Compliance Toolkit

Other Guidance:

- Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) guidance
- Government guidance on handling safeguarding allegations
- Code of Fundraising Practice
- NCVO safeguarding resources

Appendix A: Types of Risks and Harm

Harm and risks to be alert to, whether online or in person, include:

- Sexual harassment, abuse, and exploitation
- Criminal exploitation
- A charity's culture which may allow poor behaviour and poor accountability
- People abusing a position of trust within a charity
- Bullying or harassment
- Health and safety issues
- Commercial exploitation
- Cyber abuse
- Discrimination on any of the grounds in the Equality Act 2010
- People targeting the charity
- Data breaches
- Negligent treatment
- Domestic abuse
- Self-neglect
- Physical or emotional abuse
- Extremism and radicalisation
- Forced marriage
- Modern slavery
- Human trafficking
- Female genital mutilation

Appendix B: Signs of Abuse

Physical Abuse

- Bruises, black eyes, welts, lacerations, and rope marks
- Broken bones
- Open wounds, cuts, punctures, untreated injuries in various stages of healing
- Broken eyeglasses/frames, or physical signs of being punished or restrained
- Individual's report of being hit, slapped, kicked, or mistreated
- Sudden change in behaviour
- Caregiver's refusal to allow visitors to see a vulnerable person alone

Sexual Abuse

- Bruises around the breasts or genital area
- Unexplained venereal disease or genital infections
- Unexplained vaginal or anal bleeding
- Torn, stained, or bloody underclothing
- Individual's report of being sexually assaulted or raped

Emotional Abuse

- Being emotionally upset or agitated
- Being extremely withdrawn and non-communicative or non-responsive
- Nervousness around certain people
- Individual's report of being verbally or mentally mistreated

Neglect

- Dehydration, malnutrition, untreated bed sores, poor personal hygiene
- Unattended or untreated health problems
- Hazardous or unsafe living conditions
- Unsanitary and unclean living conditions
- Individual's report of being mistreated

Financial Exploitation

- Sudden changes in bank account or banking practice
- Unauthorised withdrawal of funds
- Abrupt changes in a will or other financial documents
- Unexplained disappearance of funds or valuable possessions
- Bills unpaid despite money being available
- Forging a signature on financial transactions
- Sudden appearance of previously uninvolved relatives claiming rights to possessions
- Individual's report of exploitation

19. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

20. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Safeguarding Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

--- End of Policy ---